

MYLAPORE

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Silent protest at Nageswara Rao Park today

BY A SPECIAL CORRESPONDENT

A silent protest will be held at Nageswara Rao Park on August 16 at 8 a.m. Led by patrons of the park and residents of Mylapore, the gathering is a call to the civic body to “finish the work, protect the trees and give them their park back”.

Many residents have raised an objection to the large-scale felling of trees and excessive concretisation of the park.

Last month, Supraja Srinivasan, a resident of Luz Avenue, started a petition on Change.org urging Greater Chennai Corporation to halt further concretisation, re-evaluate the plan on modernising the park and restore green spaces. Her petition garnered more than 5,600 signatures.

In an update in the online petition, she writes that despite repeated requests, GCC has not responded. “Work at Nageswara Rao Park has stalled. Concrete patches remain unfinished, trees need ur-



Residents say the park has lost many trees because of the improvement work. PHOTO: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

gent care, and with the monsoon approaching, delays will only make things worse,” she says.

The silent gathering also re-

quests participants to bring a placard that says what they feel about Nageswara Rao Park.

Nizhal, Alliance of Resident

Welfare Associations, Prakruthi and Spark are some of the groups that have lent their support to this silent meeting.

Solar Mela in Alwarpet today

Citizen Consumer and Civic Action Group (CAG) is organising a Solar Mela on August 16 at C.P. Art Centre, Eldams Road, Alwarpet, from 10 a.m. to 6 p.m, bringing together solar vendors, banks and EB officials on a common platform for consumers. Those keen on switching to solar power can have answers to questions such as how much they can save on their electricity bill with rooftop solar, installation and government subsidy related queries, choosing a right vendor and financing options that are available. To invite CAG for a similar mela in your locality, call Subramani at 88072 14008/ Aswin at 9047933740

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Move garbage bins out of waterlogged spots



Access to these garbage bins has been made difficult by waterlogging around them at the junction of Kesava Perumal East Street and Kesava Perumal South Street in Mylapore. PHOTOS: M. SRINATH

Madras Day with MTC

As part of Madras Day, the Metropolitan Transport Corporation is organising 'MTC Chennai Day 2026' with a host of competitions.

Drawing competition

For students of classes I to V, the themes are 'The Bus Transporting Me to School', 'My Family Members Commute by MTC Buses', and 'My Colourful Chennai Bus'; classes VI to VIII: 'My Chennai, My Bus', 'An Unforgettable Journey in an MTC Bus', and 'MTC Buses and Green Chennai'; and classes IX to XII, 'My view of MTC Bus in 2040', and 'One-Day in the life of MTC Bus'.

Short film contest

Madras Reel, a short-film competition, is on 'One Bus Story' where participants should drive home the message that buses play a vital role in serving commuters in their day-to-day lives. The daily life of buses, their memories, their feelings, and the city's unique culture experienced while traveling on a bus must be captured.

The short film should feature MTC buses and run for three minutes.

The photography competition is on 'Route Number tells a life story'. The photos should depict MTC buses and commuters, public transport featuring ci-



ty pictures and moments. The participants should explain how the buses are interlinked with Chennai's lives.

Poetry competition is on 'Namma Chennai Bus'.

The submission link for contests: drawing: <https://forms.gle/Jnbpw4MWPd6TMkA8>, photography: <https://forms.gle/8Scf4VwVQiXWdmT69>, short film : <https://forms.gle/wSct2ywX8KABiuB7>, poetry: <https://forms.gle/JbAnBmIo7nBrkv148>. Mail your queries to mtcchennai-socialmedia@gmail.com

The last date to send the entries is August 18, 2026. For details, visit <https://x.com/MtcChennai>

Community in Mandaveli does not 'waste' the waste

Following trial and error, Ragamalika Apartments had cracked the waste management code: it now sells compost to outside entities

RADHIKA KARTHIKEYAN

What began eight years ago with purchase of basic composting bins has grown into a sustained waste management effort at Ragamalika, a gated community in Mandaveli. As a bulk waste generator, the community is required to manage its own wet waste, but residents soon discovered that successful composting needed more than equipment – it required segregation, training and steady participation.

Initially, Ragamalika bought bulk composting bins from My Green Bin, but what followed was marked by a see-saw between a burst of activity and a lull of inactivity. Now, for the last one-and-a-half years, residents and housekeeping staff have got adjusted to the new system and are composting in earnest. By 2025, most blocks in the complex were segregating waste into three streams: recyclables, wet waste and landfill-bound waste.

Recyclables are handed over to Bintix, while about 20 kg of wet waste is processed within the community every day. Earlier, an outside service provider checked the



wet waste to ensure that plastic and other inorganic material had not entered the bins before adding microbes to the green composting units. When sorting mistakes occur, residents are informed and educated on what goes where, helping improve segregation over time.

After three service providers discontinued the work, the community asked its housekeeping staff if they would be ready to take on the responsibility for additional pay – a decision residents now count among their best.

The staff initially collected wet waste from every doorstep, spread it on a tarp to remove plastic and other inorganic pieces, and chopped larger food scraps so they would break down faster. To reduce the time and effort involved, they suggested buying a chopping



The housekeeping staff at the community.

PHOTOS: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

machine. Commercial machines, however, cost more than ₹ one lakh and were beyond the community's budget.

Maithreyi, a resident, then researched alternatives online and found a fodder chopper made in Pune that cost only one-tenth the price of commercial machines. The machine, purchased through crowdfunding, arrived a few weeks ago and has made the composting process quicker.

Smaller pieces of organic waste now decompose faster, producing nutrient-rich compost in less time while saving the housekeeping staff valuable labour. Ragamalika uses the compost and leachate to fertilise plants within the complex. Some residents also buy the compost for their balcony gardens and house plants, and the community now sells the surplus. A 5-kg bag of compost costs ₹125, while a one-litre bottle of leachate costs ₹40. Buyers are encouraged to bring their own bags and bottles, and payments are accepted only through UPI.

The project has been spearheaded by the community's Green Champions, Hetal Somasundaram and Sumanapriya, whose efforts helped turn a difficult responsibility into a model of community-led waste management.

For details, contact Hetal at 9488466778/Sumanapriya at 9444851212

Radhika Karthikeyan is a resident of the apartment





Residents want a safe pedestrian passage until the work is completed.
PHOTOS: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT



An unsafe dash across the tracks at Thiruvottiyur

Train commuters question the tardy pace of Road Under Bridge at Annamalai Nagar for which Railway Level Crossing 4 remains shut for four years now

IVA FELCHIA P

Well over four years ago, the Railway Level Crossing 4 at Annamalai Nagar, between Thiruvottiyur and Wimco Nagar, was shut “temporarily” to build a Road Under Bridge. I was in

Class VII when the barricades came up during the pandemic. Today I am in college, and the gate is still closed. For thousands of residents of Theradi and nearby streets, the promise of a subway has turned into a daily detour, and for many others, a dangerous shortcut across the tracks.

Every morning, school children with backpacks, elders, and office-goers walk along the railway line because the only alternative is a long route to Thiruvottiyur High Road. At night the pathway is dark making it especially unsafe for women. In emergencies, ambulances and two-wheelers lose critical mi-

nutes taking the longer road. Residents say there have been several accidents and deaths over the years as people, including students, are forced to cross the tracks. What was meant to improve connectivity has instead cut off the whole neighborhood.

Before the gate was closed, we could reach the main road in five minutes. Now even to buy medicines or drop a child at school, residents have to walk an extra two kilometres. Parents say they are most worried in the mornings and evenings when students walk on the tracks to get to schools in Thiruvottiyur. With no lights and broken stretches on the makeshift walkway, women returning from work avoid the route after sunset.

Southern Railway officials had

said the Road Under Bridge at LC-4 was being built to ease traffic and improve safety. But years after work began, there is little clarity on when it will be completed. Civic groups in the area have repeatedly petitioned for temporary measures: proper lighting, a fenced pedestrian path and regular police presence.

We residents are not asking for a clear deadline for the RUB, interim lighting and barricading along the walkway, and a safe pedestrian passage until the work is completed. Southern Railway and Greater Chennai Corporation must coordinate and treat this as an urgent public safety issue, not a project stuck in files.

Iva Felchia P is a resident of Theradi, Thiruvottiyur



Delayed clearance of tree branches at Arundale Street in Mylapore

On August 11, due to rains branches of a tree fell at Arundale Street in Mylapore. The branches along with other waste were not cleared until August 14 from our street.

Although Urbaser Sumeet and Greater Chennai Corporation workers regularly visit our street for various civic works, including

street cleaning, the tree waste has not been removed.

Pet parents not clearing dog poop is another concern.

The tree waste should be cleared immediately, and proper measures taken to maintain cleanliness.

Mohamed Nihar is a resident of Arundale Street in Mylapore

For that dream medical college



The counselling process for admission to MBBS and BDS courses in the state got under way at Tamil Nadu Government Multi Super-Speciality Hospital, Omandurar Government Estate recently.
PHOTO: SRINATH M

You can be our volunteer writer

Dear readers, you can be our volunteer-writer by writing to us about issues and events in your neighbourhood. You should send the write-ups to downtownfeedback@thehindu.co.in. Letters must carry the contact number.





Bazaar Road in Mylapore.

Metro works, loyalty works too

With Metro Rail work taking over a vast chunk of Kutchery Road, footfall at Bazaar Road in Mylapore has reduced. Despite the odds, old enterprises on this retail street have reasons to stay positive

LAKSHMY HARIKRISHNAN

At the point where Kutchery Road is “amputated” by Metro Rail work, two streets peel away in opposite directions. The workaday realities of these two streets, Devadi Street and Bazaar Road, are also on contrasting trajectories ever since this work took over a section of Kutchery Road shutting it down for regular traffic. Devadi Street has become overly industrious working indefatigably shoulder-to-shoulder with Nadu Street to funnel vehicular traffic from North Mada Street into Kutchery Road towards Santhome High Road. It also entertains wheels from Appu Street. While wheels have increased on Devadi Street, the footfall has simultaneously reduced on Bazaar Road.

Shopping is a languid, leisurely experience; hive off the comfort factor and you detract a vital component from that experience. When Kutchery Road was fully available to motorists and pedestrians, shopping on Bazaar Road felt natural. Now, with diversions and circuitous detours, it feels forced. Unless there are strong reasons to transact business over a shop counter, people are going to find alternatives; and digital pathways keep those alternatives flowing freely.

But Bazaar Road is attractive on account of enterprises that have established a strong presence over decades of retail commerce. Amidst shops that have regularly changed their name boards and trade are a multiplicity of enterprises that have persisted with one trade and built immense social cap-

ital, installing an emotional hotline with its customers. Examples abound. Here is a handful of them.

As anywhere else, a strong USP principle works like a charm. For A. Bhaskar, who runs Jayakumar Mill (which is around 70 years old) as well as a chekku oil shop, along with his brother A. Kumar, his grinding machines stay heard on Bazaar Road above the subterranean rumble of tunnel-boring machines on Kutchery Road because of unique offerings.

The machines grind the familiar. To name a few, rice, gram, and wheat flour, turmeric, vermilion and ragi and health mixes for young mothers after childbirth. And one machine grinds *nalangu maavu* (herbal bath power), and that has made a huge difference. Besides, as Bhaskar points out, his customers value the fact that this mill dedicates a grinding machine to each variety of items to be ground. So, business keeps plopping into those wide funnel-shaped feed hoppers. The challenge, Bhaskar observes, is more from people's increasing preference for packaged foods than the reduced access caused by Metro Rail work. Bhaskar believes opening even one access route on the Metro Rail-impacted section of Kutchery Road could bring back some of the footfall.

A similar disruption has affected New Shiva Country Drugs and Herbs on Bazaar Road, says its owner R. Prakash. Nearly 90 years old, the store began as a herbal medicine shop under Prakash's grandfather and gradually expanded into pooja articles, dry fruits, and bamboo products. With monsoon come sniffles, and a rush of customers,

but through the year, there is a steady flow of commerce, thanks to older customers who grew up relying on country remedies and younger ones who have inherited that faith from their families. Prakash notes that New Shiva has branches at Thanithurai Market and North Mada Street, also in Mylapore.

Scattered presence helps, particularly in these times. Prakash notes that online business of country medicine is greater challenge to ford.

For seller of earthen pots Gunasundari N., the going is palpably tough. But the resilience is tougher still. The thinning of the customer base, she believes, has resulted largely from changing lifestyles, the earthen pots she sells cracking under the magnetic pull of ever-silver wares. The pots, once a familiar presence in Mylapore homes, are in an unequal battle with ever-silver and aluminium vessels that promise convenience and durability. Obviously, the challenge glowering at Gunasundari is not only a metallic shift in tastes. The road itself poses a challenge now, as it now draws fewer people stopping to browse or buy.

Her voice drops to a plaintive murmur when she says, “There are days I go home without earning anything.” But brining the curtains down on the business does not enter her mind. That resilience pretty much sums up the attitude of the old shops at Bazaar Road in Mylapore.

Ahead of Madras Day, Resilience Series tracks old markets in the city that are under the shadow of a major civic infrastructure work but are soldiering on with inimitable poise

The icing on the cake

Though 121 years old, The Crown Bakery on Bazaar Road stays young, thanks to suggestions coming in from Gen Zers in the family that runs the enterprise

LAKSHMY HARIKRISHNAN

At Bazaar Road in Mylapore, lined with a diversity of shops, “hoary-haired” enterprises show up with impressive frequency. Established in 1905, The Crown Bakery wins the demographic tug-of-war among these old enterprises hands down.

Established in 1905 by Kantasamy Mudaliar, the reins of the shop would be passed on to the current family, the descendants of Srinivasan, an admirable torch-bearer of this patiently baked legacy, for several decades.

While Srinivasan's daughter Bhavani Srinivasan manages the shop, the younger generation is parked in the wings, stepping in from time to time to bring its own energy and ideas to the oven.

Twenty-three-year-old Keerthana V, Bhavani's niece and Srinivasan's granddaughter and one who epitomises the Gen Z engagement, recalls a brainstorming session by the Gen Zers in the family that resulted in the introduction of ice cream cakes to the bakery's bill of fare.

The younger generation's suggestions were instrumental in the introduction of puffs and pastries and those ice cream cakes, bringing contemporariness to the bakery's repertoire.

On the subject of repertoire, the bakery also continues to make soup sticks, a simple and traditional product given to babies during teething. But there is no

cause for the old offerings (breads and buns, bun-butter jam and regular cakes) to feel threatened by this New-Age approach. The bun-butter jam remains a clear favourite with each serving prepared freshly in front of the customer rather than packaged and left on the shelf.

The old recipes remain unchanged, preserved on yellowed pieces of paper, written in an ink that defies erasure. “We do not try to fit in a particular box or overly modernise anything,” says Keerthana.

This balance is likely the reason it manages to keep its customer base as well as add steadily to it. She observes, “People have always liked what we produced over the years and hence they keep coming back.” The connection the bakery has maintained with its customers is most evident during the Yule tide. Ahead of Christmas, Crown bakery's rum-soaked plum cake, prepared with dried fruits and raisins soaked in rum for months, draws customers from across the city and beyond. Some even send cakes abroad to relatives. “I myself was craving cakes while I was in the United Kingdom and my family has sent it over multiple times,” Keerthana says.

If The Crown Bakery has managed to ford challenges in recent times, including reduced access to its doors due to Metro Rail work, it is the desire to see the enterprise survive time that is shared by family members across generations. Specifically, the Gen Z factor: there are eight grandchildren in the family. And this constituency takes pride in the bakery. Keerthana notes she or any other youngster in the family will be honoured to take it forward.



The Crown Bakery at Bazaar Road in Mylapore.



During a Solar Mela organised by CAG at Kasturba Nagar. PHOTO: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

Rooftop solar gets a fresh boost

The Tamil Nadu government announces an additional incentive to accelerate investment in solar technology. What should it focus on next?

LIFFY THOMAS

With Tamil Nadu government announcing an additional incentive of ₹22,000 for domestic consumers to instal a solar rooftop, the sun is expected to shine brighter in the state.

Under the PM Surya Ghar: Muft Bijli Yagna, a maximum subsidy of ₹78,000 for solar rooftop capacity of above 3kW is already being given. Combining the two incentives, a beneficiary can receive a total benefit of ₹1 lakh.

While those working to promote the renewable energy sector are happy with the announcement made during the Tamil Nadu Budget session held recently and are waiting for the modalities in the scheme to be made clearer, they weigh in with their suggestions.

P. Ashok Kumar, founder-president of Tamil Nadu Solar Energy Developers Association (TNSEDA), has sent a letter to the State Government to modify the scheme in such a way that energy storage devices solar batteries and inverters get a push.

“Instead of giving a direct benefit of ₹22,000, the State Government should insist consumers use energy storage devices. My suggestion is to add energy storage to the incentive and train people to use solar power 24x7 even in peak hours to reduce the dependence on Tamil Nadu Electricity Board,” says Ashok.

The current practice in Tamil Nadu is a consumer’s excess solar power is sent to the grid, letting him/her use that credit later instead of paying cash called Net Metering.

TNSEDA representation holds significance as renewable energy alone is

not enough to meet growing energy needs. Batteries are said to bolster grid stability and performance, allowing renewables to better integrate into the electrical grid. Energy storage devices will allow the energy generated during peak times to be used at a later time.

Ashok Kumar says such a nudge by the government will reduce the loss incurred by TNEB. “The cost of purchasing peak hour power is high, so the extra incentive should nudge consumers to use solar during peak hours,” he says.

Many states including those leading in solar rooftop adoption like Uttar Pradesh and Gujarat offer subsidy.

More awareness

Jaideep Saraswat, Associate Director - Clean Power, Electric Mobility and Emerging Technologies, Vasudha Foundation, a non-profit think tank working to advance clean energy and climate solutions, says their experience with accelerating PM Surya Ghar Yagna shows that a subsidy translates into real adoption only when all the pieces fit well.

“This begins with raising consumer awareness on rooftop solar systems and informing consumers about the state subsidy, which improves the pay-back period for them. Concurrently, vendor capacity must be built to ensure optimised system deployment,” says Jaideep. “Finally, the capacity of all stakeholders needs to be built and everyone must be aligned on increasing rooftop deployment.”

Other suggestions include: speed up approval process and set targets for banks and financial institutions so that more household are able to avail loan for installing solar systems.

An experience hub

Before investing in solar power, visit one of these experience centres

BY A SPECIAL CORRESPONDENT

When it comes to solar energy, experiencing is believing. At least that is idea retailers and manufacturers have started to promote, thereby nudging homeowners to transition to green energy. From first-hand exposure to solar solutions at experience centres to deploying staff at electronic stores to clarifying nagging doubts, the reasons to invest in solar energy seem to be slowly increasing for consumers.

In June, VeSat Solar Energy Systems opened a new solar experience centre at Shastri Nagar in Adyar. The building is powered entirely by solar energy including its lights, fans and three air conditioners, computers and television.

Those walking into the showroom get to see how the power of the sun can be harnessed on a range of products from water heaters to power systems.

L.R. Venkatesh, managing director, VeSat Solar, says giving prospective buyers a walk-through is not just an easy way to market a product but boosts the trust and confidence in solar energy.

“Solar is not an off the shelf product. Once you give people the experience, we visit the site, study their requirement and design it accordingly,” says Venkatesh.

Chennai-based Evolve Energy Group and Freyr Energy are among others that are fast expanding their experience centres.

Solar section in consumer outlets

Increasingly consumer durable outlets have expanded the scope of items they retail by including solar.

The 10 plus outlets of Darling Retail in Chennai, a multi-brand consumer durable chain, has staff trained to give shoppers a demo on how solar technology works. Under Darling Solar Solutions, the enterprise offers a range of services. Once a customers evinces interest, the technical team does a site inspection to study the roof size, structure, shading and energy needs. From loan application process to applying for net meter, they even support a buyer with annual maintenance.

Likewise, Ratna Fan House also offers a variety of services and has completed more than 200 solar rooftop installations so far.



SHARON JESSICA MICHAEL

Water moves in two directions across the Nemmeli coastal wetland — freshwater flowing east from inland lakes and tanks, and seawater moving inland through the Muttukadu estuary. Spread across more than 8,500 acres between Kelambakkam and Mamallapuram, the wetland is a meeting point of these two water systems, shaped by tides, rainfall and the seasons.

That landscape is now being reshaped into a freshwater reservoir. The first phase of Mamallan reservoir project covers 4,375 acres. A second phase is proposed for the remaining wetland.

The proposed reservoir will occupy a landscape marked by marshes, mudflats, shallow waters, salt pans and seasonal grasslands, spanning freshwater and brackish-water habitats. The wetland is also a seasonal stopover along the Central Asian Flyway, drawing migratory birds, while its waters support fish, prawns, crabs and other species that sustain fishing activity in the surrounding villages.

The wetland is also being documented from the ground up. Environmental groups and naturalists are recording its biodiversity through field surveys, documentaries, signature campaigns, rallies and a coffee-table book.

Nemmel's Last Tide, a documentary conceptualised by Deepak Venkatachalam of Suzhal Arivom, a grassroot level, volunteer-driven environmental education, research, and conservation group and produced by the Wetland Conservation Network, brings together voices from naturalists, scientists, maritime researchers, educators and fisher-folks to document what the wetland holds and what could be

Documentation as advocacy

Environmental groups are turning to documentary film-making and biodiversity documentation and other strategies to create awareness on how the Mamallan reservoir project would reshape the Kovalam–Nemmeli wetlands for the worse

lost.

According to Deepak, making people see the landscape is central to conservation. "We try to break that barrier by bringing in people and increasing the footfall to these places," he says, describing the need to reconnect people with nature through direct experience and visual storytelling. "The landscape has so much life. It is a very complex, intricate ecosystem. It cannot be recreated at any cost once it is depleted."

That life is reflected in the numbers. Suzhal Arivom's documentation records 232 species in the Nemmeli Wetland complex, with nearly 45,000 birds counted during the 2025-26 peak season. A count of 16,000 migratory ducks, spread across half-a-dozen species, was recorded.

The wetland is also an important node in the Central Asian Flyway, with 88 migratory species recorded.

The documentation extends beyond birds. In January 2026, Suzhal Arivom recorded an established colony of Burmann's Sundew (*Drosera burmannii*) at five GPS-verified locations. The tiny carnivorous plant survives in acidic, nutrient-poor, seasonally waterlogged soils making its presence an indicator of relatively

undisturbed wetland conditions.

A parallel effort has come from the Palluyir Trust, a group for Nature Education and Research, founded in 2021 by naturalists, through its coffee-table book *Kovalam-Nemmeli Coastal Wetland: A Biodiversity Montage*. Combining photographs with species information, the book records the wetland's birds, insects, benthic life, mangroves and other flora. Crucially, it was printed and sent to bureaucrats, MLAs and government authorities, accompanied by letters highlighting the wetland's ecological importance and concerns over the proposed reservoir. A digital version is also available on their official website.

The documentation also places these species within the wider wetland ecosystem, its mudflats, marshes, shallow waters and vegetation which provide feeding and breeding grounds for aquatic life and habitat for migratory birds. It also records the wetland's links to fishing livelihoods and

flood protection.

"The idea is we are trying as many strategies as possible to make people feel for that place and be moved by the life there," Yuvan says. For him, the question is also whether a freshwater reservoir can ever be considered an "alternative" to this landscape. "A freshwater body does not belong by the beach," he argues, pointing to the difference between inland reservoirs and tidal wetlands.

Fewer fish, less income

Fisherfolk from more than 16 villages depend on the Kovalam-Nemmeli wetlands, with nearly 7,000 families relying on its shallow waters to collect prawns, crabs, oysters and other species. Unlike mechanised fishers, they work largely by hand and foot, following Irall Thazhuvuthal, the traditional practice of catching prawns and fish by hand. The Paraval, as they locally call the coastal wetland, has 18 distinct habitats, with the Purattasi season (mid-September to mid-October) bringing the highest catch. During this period, a family can earn ₹1 lakh-₹3 lakh, an income that can sustain them through much of the year.

The proposed reservoir threa-

tens this livelihood system. About 5,000 acres of the wetland is proposed to be converted into an impounded freshwater reservoir, with Phase I covering 65% Kazhuveli marshland and 35% Uppan-gazhi salt pans. Fisherfolk who have depended on these waters for generations, the loss could mean shrinking incomes and a shift to unfamiliar and precarious work.

For Kovalam R. Narayanan, the impact of the Mamallan Reservoir Project can be measured in the distance between what fishing once earned his family and what it brings in today. A fisherman from Kovalam, Narayanan began fishing at 11 and has continued in the occupation for decades. The earnings have now dwindled considerably. Narayanan links the decline partly to what has happened to fishermen who once worked in the coastal wetlands. As access to the wetland has reduced with the progress of the reservoir project, he said, many of those fishermen have moved to the sea.

That has changed the arithmetic of fishing. "Earlier, there were around 500 fishermen fishing in the sea and another 500 depending on the wetlands. Now all 1,000 are going to the sea," he said. More boats and more fishers are consequently chasing the same marine catch, he said, leaving each fisher with a smaller share. "The wetlands earmarked for the project are not an empty expanse waiting to be developed. They are a living ecosystem supporting an intricate network of species and livelihoods" said Narayanan.

Link to the documentary <https://tinyurl.com/NemmeliDoc>
Palluyir Trust - @palluyir-trust.org

Rich bird life at
Kovalam–Nemmeli wetlands



Five decades of excellence and service

The Golden Jubilee Annual Day of P.S. Senior Secondary School was celebrated recently

P.S. Senior Secondary School celebrated its Golden Jubilee Annual Day with grandeur at Narada Gana Sabha on August 7 and 8. The two-day celebration brought together eminent dignitaries, distinguished alumni, faculty members, students and well-wishers, marking a significant milestone in the institution's history.

On the first day, Correspondent P. S. Prabhakar welcomed the gathering and spoke about the significance of the institution's Golden Jubilee, reflecting on its five decades of educational excellence and service, said a release.

Chief Guest T. R. Santhana Krishnan, Chairman, Data Tracks, Singapore, emphasised the need to approach artificial intelligence with responsibility, understanding and



commitment. He highlighted the pivotal role of teachers in shaping young minds through character building. P. C. Ramakrishna, Chairman of the school, traced the institution's growth and development over the years. Revathy Parames-

waran, Principal, presented the Annual Report, highlighting the school's academic, co-curricular and extracurricular achievements during the academic year 2025-26. The Golden Jubilee magazine, Panorama, was released by the

Chief Guest, with the first copy received by C. V. Krishnan, Secretary, P.S. Educational Society.

The second day of the celebrations was graced by Dr. J. Radhakrishnan, Director, Anna Institute of Management and Training, as the

chief guest. V. Kamakoti, Director, IIT Madras and an alumnus of P.S. Senior Secondary School, was the Guest of Honour.

Kamakoti fondly recalled his school days and encouraged students to pursue excellence not only in academics but also in co-curricular activities.

A special highlight of the occasion was the release of The Golden Chronicle, the Coffee Table Book chronicling the 50 glorious years of P.S. Senior Secondary School. The book was released by the chief guest and the first copy was received by V. Kamakoti.

Distinguished faculty members were presented with the Vidya Ganapathi Awards and Long Service Awards. Student achievers who had excelled in academics and sports were also felicitated for their outstanding accomplishments.

The grand finale featured a spectacular cultural presentation titled "Srinivasa Tirukkalyanam", a blend of music, dance and Tamil theatre, added the release.

A workshop aimed to remove fear of maths

Students from five city schools take part in 'Raising a Mathematician' organised by Justice Basheer Ahmed Sayeed College for Women

The Department of Mathematics (Shift I), Justice Basheer Ahmed Sayeed College for Women (Autonomous), in collaboration with ThinkMath Foundation, organised a workshop for school students on the theme "Raising a Mathematician."

Vidya Shankar Chakravarthy, founder, ThinkMath Foundation, spoke on how math is the language which we all are aware yet fear blocks this natural tendency from understanding the relevance in daily lives. Teaching concepts in

a student friendly way is the only way to break the wall of Math anxiety.

Resource person for the workshop, Sadagopan Rajesh, mathematics educator, conducted an engaging and interactive session for the students. Through thought-provoking activities and an enthusiastic approach, he encouraged students to look at Mathematics beyond textbooks, formulas and examinations.

The workshop focused on removing the fear of mathematics, developing logical and analytical

thinking, encouraging curiosity and instilling the essence of Mathematics with an emotional connection, said a release. The students were motivated to approach mathematical problems with confidence, creativity and perseverance.

Students from five schools – Unity Public School, Kottur; Unity Matriculation School; Agarwal Vidyalaya and Junior College; Vedavalli School, Ranipet and Walajpet; and Fathima Basheer Matriculation Higher Secondary School – took part.

Cyber crime awareness session

HelpAge India in association with Tamilnadu Senior Citizen Association is organising a cyber crime awareness programme on August 27.

Types of cyber frauds, ways to avoid scams and how to seek help are some topics that will be covered.

Venue: Tamilnadu Senior Citizens' Association, Anna Nagar. To register, call 9840933272/ 9159734547



TN Governor soft-launches MSS App

Recently, TN Governor Rajendra Vishwanath Arlekar, soft-launched the MSS App (MSME Schemes Search App) at Bharathiar Mandapam in Lok Bhavan, Chennai.

The application has been jointly developed by Swadeshi Shodh Sansthan (SSS) - Tamil Nadu Chapter and Rajalakshmi Institute of Technology with the objective of enabling MSMEs and aspiring youth to easily discover and access Government schemes, financial

assistance programmes through a single digital platform, says a press release. The application is designed to simplify access to information relating to Central and State Government initiatives, particularly for first-generation entrepreneurs and citizens in rural and semi-urban areas. The initial release supports both English and Tamil, with additional features and services proposed in subsequent phases, the release adds.

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Through Surya School of Music, Prabha Gurumurthy has given many differently abled a stage to be seen and heard



BY A SPECIAL CORRESPONDENT

Surya School of Music completed a milestone recently. On August 9, the music school catering to children and young adults with special needs celebrated its fifth anniversary and its 300th stage event with a multi-talent show to enter the Nova World Records. This is the fourth time students of the school put up a show to enter a record book, each presenting their talent to be seen and heard.

Prabha Gurumurthy, granddaughter of legendary actor and singer T.R. Mahalingam, is behind this initiative aimed at identifying the talent in children with special

Special notes



▼ Dr H.V. Hande was the chief guest at the anniversary celebration held recently; (below) Prabha Gurumurthy.

needs and giving them a stage to perform.

For nearly two decades, this music teacher has been taking on-line classes for able-bodied children in bhajans, slokas and devotional songs. During the pandemic, Prabha expanded the scope of her classes to include the differently abled.

A youngster on the spectrum approached the music teacher with a grouse that he never got a chance to perform like other children. That actually got Prabha thinking and doing something for those with disabilities.

"The success of two batches of classes that I took during the pandemic encouraged me to start the music school," says Prabha, a resident of Mylapore.

From 15 differently abled students, today Prabha has nearly 80 students learning lessons from



her at a space managed by V-Excel Educational Trust in Mandaveli; a majority are above 18 years and many are non-verbal.

From karokae, orchestra, classic retro, cine songs, solo to duets, exclusive to inclusive shows, the children have adapted themselves to every new stage performance. "Opportunities, limelight, recognition, appreciation have boosted the children's confidence and self

esteem. And, music definitely calms all children," says Prabha.

She says with a positive approach and tailoring the lessons to suit each child one can train specially abled youngsters in music. To commemorate Tamil poet and lyricist Kaviarasu Kannadasan's centenary year, 100 shows are being discussed and Prabha plans to be a part of this celebration with her students.

"As a mark of gratitude, I wanted to do something good for Kaviarasu. Our upcoming events will feature his songs sung by my students," says Prabha, who is in her mid-50s and a member of the Rotary Club of Chennai Octave.

Among other plans are teaching students instrumental music and supporting them through a livelihood initiative.

Prabha can be contacted at 8939117387

Hospital performs rare surgery

SRM Prime Hospital performed a surgery of a 52-year-old man from Jharkhand. According to a press release, it is a "reconstructive surgery" which is considered rare and complex.

The patient had neglected a fracture-dislocation of his left shoulder for nearly six months. Over time, the untreated injury progressed to a chronic dislocation, leading to extensive soft-tissue scarring, formation of a pseudo-joint elsewhere, and compression of the brachial plexus, the network of nerves that controls movement and sensation in the shoulder, arm and hand.

Using advanced surgical techniques and a multidisciplinary approach, the medical team successfully restored the shoulder to its anatomical position while carefully protecting and decompressing the major nerves and blood vessels nearby, adds the press release.

The patient was discharged after five days in the hospital with significant pain relief. The surgery was carried out by a multidisciplinary team comprising Dr. Nikhil Jawaharlal Nahar, Consultant - Shoulder & Orthopaedic Surgeon; Dr. Lokesh Suryanarayanan, Consultant - Plastic Surgery along with Dr. Subashini, Senior Consultant - Plastic Surgery; Dr. K Partheeban, Clinical Lead & Senior Consultant - Anaesthesia, adds the press release.

Music school in Abhiramapuram establishes strong online presence



Seetha Chidambaram founded the Oppilal School of Music and Arts 15 years ago in Abhiramapuram in memory of Oppilal (which means "unparalleled").

The school has now established a strong digital presence, offering course online, says a press release. One can check out its YouTube channel (<https://www.youtube.com/@oppilalschoolofmusicfi>-

near9232) to get a sense of what it has to offer. The school song 'Pannisaikum Pavallargal' in Kalyani ragam, composed by teacher Vasundaradevi and rendered by Subhashree Thanikachalam's group on the school's YouTube, is gripping, it points out.

The school curriculum is marked by the ancient classical music of the Thevaram and Thirupugal and many other Tamil compositions.

Onam festivities from August 17

Bharatiya Vidya Bhavan celebrates Onam with a five-day festival titled "Bhavananam" starting August 17 at its main auditorium in Mylapore. The events happening from August 17 to 21 are open to all and begin at 6.30 p.m.

From captivating Kathakali, Malayalam short plays, Kerala musical ensemble like Thiruvathirakali, Mudiattam, Panchari Melam, Ottanthulal, the festival will immerse audiences in the unique charm of God's Own Country.

The events on August 23 will be held at the Kilpauk auditorium.

August 17 - Kathakali - Naragasura Vadham

August 18 - Kerala musical ensemble

August 20 - Malayalam short plays

August 21 - Avani - A Kerala cultural odyssey

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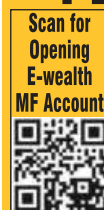
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